APEX LARK — DAY 05 BUSINESS REPORT

Advanced Business Analysis Using Excel Lookup Functions & Dynamic Reporting | Sample Superstore | 9,993 cleaned transaction lines | 2014–2017

TOTAL SALES	TOTAL PROFIT	TOTAL CUSTOMERS	TOTAL ORDERS	PROFIT MARGIN
$2,296,919	$286,409	793	5,009	12.5%

1. Report Design & Data Integration

The workbook is organized into four core worksheets: **Sales_Data** stores transaction-level records; **Customer_Data** contains one row per customer with segment and customer-level metrics; **Product_Data** contains one row per product with category, sub-category, average realized unit price and sales/profit totals; and **Final_Report** combines the data through lookup formulas and presents KPIs, summaries, charts and transaction-level classifications. A separate Lookup_Functions sheet documents the requested formulas.

2. Business Performance Findings

Region	Sales
West	$725,458
East	$678,500
Central	$501,240
South	$391,722

Category	Sales	Profit
Technology	$836,154	$145,455
Office Supplies	$719,047	$122,491
Furniture	$741,718	$18,463

3. Logical Analysis & Conditional Formatting

Sales are classified as High (≥ $1,000), Medium (≥ $250 and < $1,000), or Low (< $250). Profit Status distinguishes positive-profit transactions from non-profitable transactions using AND(). Review Flag identifies discounts of 30% or more or any loss-making line using OR(). IFERROR() supplies readable fallback messages for failed lookups. Conditional formatting highlights high/low sales, negative profit and records requiring review.

4. Data Limitations & Interpretation

Customer names are not included in the supplied Sample Superstore source; therefore, customer ID is used to identify the highest-contributing customer, and the Customer Name lookup returns “Not provided in source data.” The source also has no list-price field. Unit Price is therefore represented as the average realized transaction price (Sales ÷ Quantity) by product, not a manufacturer list price. Region is transaction-level information and is carried from Sales_Data.

5. Recommendations

1. Review loss-making and high-discount transactions before approving deep discounts; prioritize sub-categories with negative profit.

2. Use the West region’s revenue performance as a benchmark and investigate how its product mix, pricing and customer behavior differ from lower-revenue regions.

3. Protect high-value customer relationships and maintain availability of products/categories that contribute the strongest sales and profit.

Source: ApexLark Day 04 workbook (Cleaned Data sheet) and supplied Sample Superstore CSV. Figures in this report are calculated from the 9,993 transaction rows used in Day 04.